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to Bronx. The unvanquished star here was an exuberant piece of rotundity called Daler Mehndi. Bouncy, with hints of the old Mirasi troubadour from the countryside, and delivered in shiny spandex to the world. Nor did his peers give any hint of wanting to return to a local shell, certainly not Malkit Singh with his British-Indian DJ pal Bally Sagoo. Crossing boundaries was the norm, not the exception—not just in Bhangra. Ghazal star Hariharan teamed up with the rock-minded Leslee Lewis to create Colonial Cousins. Even a Shubha Mudgal ventured joyfully into folk-pop.

Did Indian TV show signs of its mental universe opening up to this cultural glasnost? Well, yes and no. *Kaun Banega Crorepati* (debut: 2000) was an adaptation of *Who Wants to Be a Millionaire*? But the thicker currents were all about relapsing into 'tradition'—at least, an ornate, self-conscious rehearsal of it. *Kyunki Saas Bhi Kabhi Bahu Thi* was its acme. Those like *C.I.D.* and *Shaktimaan* reprised western tropes, but to describe them one might pun on another Bollyhit of the era, from the Karan Johan stable: Kitsch Kitsch Hota Hai. ■